GPT Q1

LX / Tech: Sprache und Technologie - Language and Technology

niemand sollte umsonst arbeiten

Date: 2026-05-20
class: [16830] Sprache und Technologie - Language and Technology:: tutor: frankowsky :: term: SS26
snc: 16175.1
snc: 16132. ɪ ʃ ɔ : ʁ wer es [pɛʟɛχɪʟ] ausspricht, und nicht [pɛʀɛχɪʟ]

Table of contents

random chat… 2

16214.gpt.q 2

Q 2

A 2

1. Collapse of provenance . . . 3
2. Epistemic feedback loops . . . 3
3. Model collapse . . . 4
4. Distortion of minority reality . . . 4
5. Separation between coherence and truth . . . 5
6. Emergence of “consensus reality generators” . . . 5
7. Possible countermeasures . . . 6
   - Provenance tracking . . . 6
   - Trusted corpora . . . 6
   - Retrieval over generation . . . 6
   - Synthetic data filtering . . . 6
   - Reality anchoring . . . 7
8. Philosophical implication . . . 7

references 7

TO GIT COMMIT

```
[1] "engine on..."
```

snc

- 16215.1.2

random chat...

Q: chatGPT and Schwarz (2026)

16214.gpt.q

Q

wie war nochmal die frage?:)

A

This is one of the central epistemic problems for future language models: recursive synthetic training.

A simplified loop looks like this:

1. humans write internet text
2. models train on human text
3. models generate new internet text
4. future models train on mixtures of human + model text
5. the proportion of synthetic text increases each generation

Eventually:

- the training corpus becomes partially self-referential.

That has deep consequences.

---

1. Collapse of provenance

Historically, web text had an implicit anchoring:

- journalism
- books
- institutional records
- human testimony
- scientific publication
- forum discussions tied to lived experience

Even when wrong, those originated from some contact with reality.

Synthetic text weakens that anchoring.

Future corpora may contain:

- paraphrases of paraphrases
- generated summaries of generated summaries
- hallucinations repeated across thousands of sites
- mutually reinforcing but source-free claims

The model then learns: not "what happened," but "what text statistically survived circulation."

Truth becomes partially detached from origin.

---

2. Epistemic feedback loops

Suppose an early model hallucinates:

> "Scientist X proposed theory Y in 1974."

Blogs copy it. SEO pages reproduce it. AI summaries restate it. Aggregators absorb it.

A later model sees:

- many independent-looking confirmations.

Statistically, the claim now *looks true*.

This creates:

- synthetic consensus.

The dangerous part: the model's confidence calibration improves *internally* while correspondence to reality worsens externally.

---

3. Model collapse

There is already literature on this ("model collapse").

If you repeatedly train on synthetic outputs:

- rare information disappears
- variance shrinks
- distributions flatten
- edge cases vanish
- language becomes more generic and self-similar

Like making a photocopy of a photocopy repeatedly.

Over generations:

- entropy structure degrades,
- not increases.

The model converges toward:

- highly probable,
- averaged,
- stereotyped representations.

Unexpected truths disappear first.

---

4. Distortion of minority reality

Human reality is uneven and messy.

Synthetic corpora preferentially amplify:

- dominant narratives
- SEO-optimized formulations
- culturally central viewpoints
- statistically common phrasing

Marginal experiences become underrepresented.

Future models may therefore:

- speak more smoothly,
- while knowing less about actual diversity of lived reality.

---

5. Separation between coherence and truth

This is perhaps the deepest issue.

Language models optimize:

- predictive coherence, not:
- ontological truth.

As synthetic text increases, future models may become extraordinarily coherent while drifting away from empirical grounding.

You could get propositions that are:

- internally reinforced,
- stylistically authoritative,
- widely repeated, yet false.

The danger is not obvious nonsense. The danger is plausible epistemic simulation.

---

6. Emergence of "consensus reality generators"

If enough institutions use model-generated summaries:

- search engines,
- news digests,
- educational material,
- corporate reports,
- legal drafting,

then models stop merely describing consensus.

They begin manufacturing it.

That changes the role of AI from: epistemic mirror to epistemic infrastructure.

---

7. Possible countermeasures

Future systems will likely require stronger grounding mechanisms:

Provenance tracking

Cryptographic/source lineage:

- human-authored?
- model-generated?
- citation chain?

Trusted corpora

Heavily curated datasets:

- scientific archives
- verified records
- primary documents

Retrieval over generation

Dynamic lookup becomes more important than static memorization.

Synthetic data filtering

Detect and down-weight AI-generated text.

Reality anchoring

Connection to:

- measurements,
- sensors,
- experiments,
- human verification.

---

8. Philosophical implication

There is a strange inversion here.

Human language evolved because organisms needed coordination about reality.

But sufficiently recursive synthetic language can become:

- self-sustaining without reality contact.

A future model might become excellent at predicting: what other models would say, rather than: what the world is like.

In that regime, “truth” risks being replaced by: stable linguistic equilibrium.

references

chatGPT, and St. Schwarz. 2026. “How Recent Chats and Discourse Model Future LLM Output.” In *Cite Yourself Dummy. A Transformer Conversation.*, 1–16214. Berlin. https://stschwarz.userpage.fu-berlin.de/links?title=gpt-con&ref=cite.